

AUGUST 1-15, 1979

Politics of Opportunism

For the leader of India's 10 million Jats it was the ultimate ecstasy. For the remaining millions watching the death-throes of the Janata Party, the moment was devoid of agony or ecstasy but consumed by wholesale indifference. Few tears were shed over Morarji Desai's political demise. As the ailing 77-year-old Charan Singh prepared for his siesta at his Tughlak Road residence on July 26, the crucial call from Rashtrapati Bhavan came through. President Neelam Sanjeeva Reddy had officially summoned him to form a government. An hour later, Singh's home was deluged by members of his Kisan Sammelan, distributing sweet lumps of *gur* and shouting slogans. With that began the descent of Indian politics to its lower depths; a new phase of degradation of the power game was exposed, and the venal opportunism of a decrepit gang of men and women guided by almost slut-tish self-interest was forced down the throats of people.

Arul B. Louis and Sunil Sethi



CHARAN SINGH

to look after the beast, like the Tiger Task Force. This agency made a lot of noise but barely did anything to protect the tigers. Did any political party—national or regional—include environment, forests or wild life protection in its manifesto? Did our honourable prime minister who heads the National Board for Wildlife do any thing to protect these big cats? It is high time for us to do what we never did or else it would be too late.

Dr A.R. MASLEKAR, Pune

Four, and Counting

Pawan Kumar Chamling, a performer who has never failed to deliver, is perhaps the best bet for Sikkim ("Forever, and Ever and Ever", June 1). His fourth consecutive term as state's chief minister speaks volumes about his relentless efforts to work for the betterment of the people of Sikkim. No wonder, he doesn't even carry a mobile phone. He wants his work to do all the talking.

MARUTPAL BHATTACHARYA,
via www.indiatoday.in

Left Out

Given their disciplined and committed cadre and the reputation for high integrity of their leaders, the Left parties could have become the first choice of voters but because of their blind adherence to a discarded political and economic ideology, they are on their way to extinction

("Turn Left for Exit", May 25). Ironically, the transfer of leadership in their main constituent, the CPI(M), from the old guard to the young has made no dent in its obscurantist thinking. After all, old habits die hard.

Y.G. CHOUKSEY, Pune

War and Peace

Winning the war is only half the battle won for President Mahinda Rajapakse ("The End",

rehabilitate the displaced population. The Rajapakse Government also needs to walk the talk on seeking enduring peace in the island nation.

NALINI VIJAYARAGHAVAN,
Thiruvananthapuram

Corrigendum

A report on corporate finance ("The Fund Chasers", May 25) incorrectly carried a picture of Shishir Kumar Bajjal, CEO of PFH



To address Muslims, the UPA must not just make empty promises. It must give them fair representation in the Government and a role in decision-making instead.

S.M. GOTHOSKAR, Mumbai

June 1). With the war-torn nation's economy being stretched to its fullest, it is undoubtedly going to be a daunting task ahead for President Rajapakse. He needs to rebuild the nation by accommodating the aspirations of both the majority Sinhalese and the minority Tamil communities as it is strategically important to

Investment Advisory Co. Ltd., instead of Shishir Bajaj, chairman and managing director of Bajaj Hindusthan Limited. A picture of Shishir Bajaj appears with this corrigendum. The error is regretted.



SHISHIR BAJAJ

EDITOR

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